

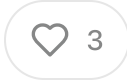
The Intraday Seasonality of Market Trends

When Is the Market Most Likely to Trend Intraday?



CONCRETUM RESEARCH

AUG 07, 2026 • PAID



In this article, we study the **intraday seasonality of trend-following strategies** S&P 500.

In simple terms, we want to understand **when, during the trading session, S&P 500 is more likely to generate trend-following profits, and whether 1 pattern has changed over time.**

This study was motivated by questions from our readers, who noticed, at least qualitatively, that SPY seemed to trend less consistently during certain parts of the trading session.

The goal of this article is to **test this hypothesis empirically** using our data and an **ensemble of six different intraday trend-following models.**

We begin by introducing the models. We then construct an ensemble portfolio to reduce model-specific noise in the results. Finally, we evaluate intraday seasonality over the full sample and investigate whether it has changed in recent years.

Cookie Policy

We use cookies to improve your experience, for analytics, and for marketing. You can accept, reject, or manage your preferences. See our [privacy policy](#).

Manage

Reject

Accept

session.



Intraday Trend-Following

Over the past few years, we have published several empirical studies on intraday trend-following strategies in U.S. equity markets.

Many of these ideas were first introduced by traders such as Toby Crabel, Li Raschke, Larry Connors, Monroe Trout, and others in the early '90s. The basic intuition is simple: when price moves significantly away from a reference price level during the intraday session, the move may reflect a genuine imbalance between supply and demand.

Given our belief that capital can only move gradually through the market, we think these imbalances can persist throughout the trading session, allowing intraday trend traders to capitalize on them.

Cookie Policy

We use cookies to improve your experience, for analytics, and for marketing. You can accept, reject, or manage your preferences. See our [privacy policy](#).

trading frequencies, and, in many cases, also shared the Python code we used to run the backtests.

For readers interested in the background, three useful references are our previous articles: *Beat the Market*, *Can Day Trading Really Be Profitable?*, and *VWAP: The Holy Grail for Day Trading Systems*.

In this article, we use an **ensemble of intraday trend-following models** that are very similar to the type of models we use in our own portfolios.

The reason we use an ensemble of models is simple: if we study only one model, the result may be driven by that model's own rules. On the other hand, if we **combine several models that all try to capture intraday trend continuation in slightly different ways**, we have a better chance of isolating the underlying market behavior.

An Ensemble of Models

We use six intraday trend models. All of them trade SPY, the most liquid ETF tracking the S&P 500.

Below is a description of each model used in the study.

This post is for paid subscribers

Subscribe

Cookie Policy

We use cookies to improve your experience, for analytics, and for marketing. You can accept, reject, or manage your preferences. See our [privacy policy](#).

← Previous

© 2026 Concretum Group · [Privacy](#) · [Terms](#) · [Collection notice](#)
[Substack](#) is the home for great culture

Cookie Policy

We use cookies to improve your experience, for analytics, and for marketing. You can accept, reject, or manage your preferences. See our [privacy policy](#).